

Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: read the earth-mother hymn and discuss imagery.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* (IAST: Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam; lit. “the world is one family” — Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **The text.** Atharva Veda 12.1 — *Pṛthivī Sūkta* (Hymn to the Earth). 63 verses. Most extensive ancient ecological text in the Vedic corpus.
2. **Key verses.** Read aloud (in IAST + English): > *mātā bhūmiḥ putro ahaṁ pṛthivyāḥ* — “Earth is my mother, I am her son.” (12.1.12) > *yat te bhūme vikhanāmi kṣipraṁ tad api rohatu* — “What I dig from the Earth, may it grow back swiftly.” (12.1.35)
3. **The framing.** Earth as mother. Resource extraction as legitimate but bounded by replenishment. Cleanliness, beauty, biodiversity as goods to preserve.
4. **Cross-cultural.** Earth-mother concept appears in many cultures: Pachamama (Andean), Gaia (Greek). The Atharva Veda articulation is older than most extant references.
5. **Critical reading.** The hymn is a religious text. It articulates an ETHIC, not an empirical claim. “*Does treating Earth as mother make us better stewards? Or does it sometimes lead to passive acceptance of destructive practices (‘Earth will heal’)?*” Both views exist.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1).

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).